



Microsoft's tablet adventures

Microsoft to compete with iPad with Surface, a tablet based on the upcoming Windows 8.
<http://dgit.in/KjYPkH>

Siri Vs Aisha

Check out thinkdigit's coverage of Siri v/s Aisha shootout. The results may surprise you.
<http://dgit.in/MIPXL2>

Programmed saving to Dropbox:

- If you're uncomfortable with saving documents in two places at once or having to change the default save location to your Dropbox folder, Mac OS X and Linux-based systems let you create symbolic links to ease your problem. In essence, your files are stored at one fixed place (preferably your Dropbox folder) and you create links to the same file or folder elsewhere on your hard disk. For example, if you have a bunch of important documents stored in your home folder under ~/Documents and your Dropbox folder is located at ~/Dropbox, start by moving your Documents folder to inside Dropbox: `mv -r ~/Documents ~/Dropbox`
- Next, create a symbolic link to your Documents folder (now located within your Dropbox folder) to its earlier (original) location:

```
ln -s ~/Dropbox/Documents ~/Documents
```

You can now continue to save files to your original Documents folder and Dropbox will sync your files for you! (<http://dgit.in/KNEHZu>)

- If your existing Dropbox folder is a mess, Sort My Box is a nifty little service that organizes your files for you, based on rules that you define. You can choose to organize files by extension, date or filename. Put all your unsorted files into your SortBox folder inside your Dropbox folder, and Sort My Box will automatically move the files into the appropriate folder for you.

Remote Access:

- Akira (<http://dgit.in/KGSZtf>) is a command prompt application which uses Dropbox to access a computer remotely. It requires two Windows computers—one running a server process (Latte) and another issuing commands through a command line client (Akira). You can grab files from anywhere on the remote computer, take a screenshot of the screen and save it in your Dropbox folder, run applications, shut down the PC, or even launch a web site in the default browser.



URL Droplet

- Configure your BitTorrent/uTorrent client to monitor a Dropbox folder and immediately initiate downloads when a new .torrent file is added to it. (Those using uTorrent's remote feature will find it redundant, but it's a simpler application.) You can copy a torrent file to that folder from any other device to initiate the download. Make sure your client is configured to save those downloads somewhere other than Dropbox, considering memory limitations. Start the torrent from anywhere and when you reach home, you can enjoy your content straightaway.
- Basically, any application that lets you create a watch folder is fertile ground for Dropbox. Be it Adobe Photoshop, or Handbrake, you can automate their functioning by configuring them to watch a folder in Dropbox. This way you can run processes on your mother ship, while being away from home.



Akira, if you want to go the geeky way

- Set-up remote printing using Dropbox. You can print from any device connected to the internet. Make a folder in Dropbox and run a VBS script on the printer-connected computer at your home to monitor that folder. Now send any file you want printed to that folder. You can find the script at Digital Inspiration (<http://dgit.in/LD6CiD>).

And so much more:

Get more out of the box. Use the inherent features of Dropbox to do more than usual.

- It automatically syncs your media files when you connect a camera or a smartphone to your computer via USB. You can also choose to auto-upload all your camera pics to your Dropbox automatically (Doing so can get you an extra 3 GB of free space!)
 - Web developers can store “local” copies of files they're working with on live servers in a Dropbox folder. As you edit those files from other locations/devices, they'll synchronize, so you'll always have current copies to work on.
 - Now you needn't worry about adding new songs to your iPhone via a data cable. In iTunes, go to **iTunes Preferences > Advanced tab**. Select the location of your Dropbox folder as the iTunes Media Folder Location. Just add the new media files to your Dropbox folder, and iTunes will automatically sync them to your iDevice. (You shouldn't sync the iTunes Music Library.xml file; doing so can reportedly make iTunes unstable.)
 - Put your saved game data in Dropbox for complete portability. Then, no matter what computer you're on (as long as you have the game installed), you can resume your game anytime.
 - Many IM clients let you designate a path to save your chat log. Clients such as Pidgin can be modified to save your chats within the Dropbox. Now no matter what computer you're using to chat with your friend, you can pick up where you left off.
 - Set up a future-proof productivity and personal organizer using plain text files and Dropbox. Plain text files are OS agnostic, and productivity tools like Todo.txt let you manage your tasks in a plain text format that syncs between your desktop and mobile phone using its apps for iOS and Android, all using Dropbox.
- And the list is endless. These little tips will help you customise your Dropbox experience and amend its functionality. Try them all, and write to us with your queries and comments. 